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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Wednesday, February 25, 2026

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- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rH2bPF77jw8
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[00:00:28] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[00:19:32] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:20:36] Chamber.

[00:21:37] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

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[00:25:51] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:26:59] Senate chamber.

[00:27:58] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:30:32] Senate chamber.

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[00:32:37] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:33:18] Chamber.

[00:34:19] The Senate will come to order.

[00:35:24] The Senators will please take their seats. those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Dr. Angelo Chapman from Pilgrim Journey Baptist Church in Henrico, and following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing.

[00:35:50] We will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate Page Evelyn Nazareno. - Thank you, Lieutenant Governor, Senators. Thank you for the privilege of being here today.

[00:36:08] Let us pray. The Almighty God who legislates the universe and who is above the sacred faiths of human beings, your presence is invited here today by this legislative body, by way of invocation.

[00:36:31] They invite you to dwell with them so that the spirit of goodwill shall shape their work and the well-being of the people of this state. Bestow upon them your great wisdom, so that their work might be congruent with yours.

[00:36:54] Center these collective minds and guide their paths, for it is for such a time as this that they are who they are and where they are.

[00:37:09] So consecrate their service. Let your peace rest upon them and may this commonwealth prosper because of them. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:37:58] Clerk will call the roll.

[00:38:17] All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll. You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate journal for Tuesday, February 24, 2026.

[00:38:38] - The senator from King George moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:38:54] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. - Ayes 34, no, six. - Ayes 34, no, six. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates.

[00:39:13] The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good afternoon, Madam President. Good afternoon. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of communication will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[00:39:33] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 7.

[00:39:49] Ayes 31, noes 7. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the governor. We do not have any, Madam President. We've now arrived at the time in the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in our Senate gallery.

[00:40:11] And I give my daily reminder about our procedure. A senator will rise and provide an introduction for his or her visitors. I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to provide the Senate's welcome.

[00:40:30] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I'll ask for a couple of introductions. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President and members of the body, today invocation was given by Reverend Dr. Angelo Chapman.

[00:40:53] Reverend Chapman, a native of Los Angeles, California, has resided in the Richmond area since 1982 and has served as the senior lead pastor of the Pilgrim Journey Baptist Church in Henrico for 27 years.

[00:41:12] Dr. Chapman serves as an as assistant professor of religious studies at Virginia University he is the former university passing liaison between the the university and the Baptist General Convention as as chairman of the religious studies department he is entering into his 41st year at Virginia Union having taught thousands of students along the way Reverend Chapman as the senator from Western Henrico and how we're just talking about is a guy

[00:41:50] that you sometimes I hear his message but sometimes I just like to hear his voice and he's just a such a powerful soul reminds me of my grandfather because sometimes I would be doing some work with along my grandfather and he would just start singing and every time I'm around Reverend Chapman I asked him to sing a little bit of Larry Graham because I think his voice is right there and and if you don't know Larry Graham when you get to your office listen to a little bit of Larry Graham and if you want I'll come by your office because I

[00:42:28] can sing a little Larry Graham but it's my go-to karaoke but this man is a powerful man of God that has tutor and and help and I know the senator from from Richmond with a test he has helped a lot of young ministers along the way shaped them in the Virginia Union and in the community and so madam president I hope you would give him the warm welcome of the Senate thank you senator for such a wonderful introduction and thank you Reverend Chapman for for joining us and providing the blessings and the prayer for us today in the Senate chamber we

[00:43:07] are truly indebted to you and as the senator shared your legacy lives on in the numerous individuals that you have supported through their journey to ministry. So we thank you for the work you do with countless numbers of students. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to Reverend Dr. Angelo Chapman from Henrico. Did the senior senator from Henrico have another introduction? Yes, Madam President. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam

[00:43:45] President. Madam President, also joining us in the gallery, we are joined by members of the Virginia Auto Dealers Association? Senator, they may not be here just yet. Okay. We can pause and we get the green sheet. Thank you Senator. The chair recognizes Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. I would ask that the students who are joining us from Virginia 21 please stand. I hope

[00:44:24] they're still seated in the gallery fantastic madam president virginia 21 is a statewide nonpartisan organization dedicated to equipping our college students so that they might engage thoughtfully and effectively in the civic life of our commonwealth today we are joined by 40 students from 19 colleges and universities including public and private community instance in community college institutions these students are not here simply to observe but they are here to participate and madam president I enjoy speaking with some of them in my office

[00:45:00] and I'm having my team talk with them and what I can tell you is they're very clear about their positions they're clear about the things that they care about advocating for and they are very confident in that they should be part of the process and hope that we take their positions into consideration and so I'd ask that you join me in giving them a warm Senate welcome. Well thank you senator for that introduction and I had the opportunity to briefly meet with our representatives from Virginia 21 quite the cohort this year thank you so much for all that you are doing I know you're engaged in an amazing process of

[00:45:38] learning about so many different issues and especially about how your state government works. We're delighted to welcome 19 different institutions from throughout Virginia as part of this year's cohort of Virginia 21. Just impressed by all the work that you are doing and looking forward to continued conversations with each and every one of you. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the students representing Virginia 21. The

[00:46:13] chair recognizes the senator from King George. Thank You Madam President. Rise for an introduction? The senator has the floor. Madam President, you do not have a green sheet because an old friend of mine snuck in here and intentionally did not want me to bring any attention to him. But in the gallery today seated is an old friend. His name is Pastor Gennard Reed.

[00:46:38] We grew up together. Do not hold that against him. I was listening to the senator from Henrico talk about the pastor that gave the prayer this morning. And I will tell you that Grenard does the same thing. And that is one of the things he works hardest on in the Northern Neck is mentoring young men,

oftentimes when they have met the judicial system. And he takes them under their wing. He helps them. Sometimes he calls me and we work together. But he is an inspiration and a

[00:47:15] godsend to the Northern Neck, and he was an honor young man, so I'm glad the Lord got to him and saved him in his elder age. And I don't want to embarrass Edward, but he's also Edward Reed's father, and you all see Edward working around here once in a while. But Madam President, I would ask that you give a warm welcome to Pastor Gennard Reed. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction.

[00:47:40] and my apologies to our pastor you wanted to be incognito today apparently but we are happy to shine a spotlight on you especially given all that the senator has highlighted about the tremendous work that you have done for so many and for so many in our communities so thank you for that dedication thank you for your public service senators i ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to pastor bernard reed the chair recognizes the senator from taswell

[00:48:18] thank you madam president rise for introduction the senator has the floor madam president outside today on capitol square is the virginia american revolution 250 mobile museum and i'm proud to say that the museum is being towed by a volvo truck built in dublin virginia the plant in dublin is volvo's largest truck manufacturing facility in the world and the company has invested more than 760 million dollars in the plant since 2011. the plant employs almost 3 000 people and is where all of volvo's trucks for the north american market

[00:48:58] are built near the end of last year volvo trucks north america presented an all-new volvo vnl 860 the company's flagship sleeper truck to the virginia 250 commission for use with the mobile museum i would like to introduce to the senate three of the united auto workers union members who are here on behalf of the men and women who helped build that truck nicholas quesonbury william pierce and cole curtis

[00:49:35] is in the gallery today and with them are kelly bobeck and brooke griffith they are all with the volvo group and i ask madam president that you give them the warm welcome of the virginia senate i thank the senator for that introduction and And thank you so much to our representatives from the Volvo Virginia 250 truck that is carrying such a very precious and important piece of Virginia history all throughout the Commonwealth, the Mobile Museum that highlights this year's critical commemoration of our

[00:50:13] 250th anniversary of the founding of this nation. The work you are doing is so very important, making sure that so many communities have the opportunity to enjoy and celebrate this momentous piece of not just Virginia's history but America's history. Thank you so much for all that you are doing. I tried to quickly jot down the name so we honor the work you're doing.

[00:50:38] Nicholas, William, Cole, Kelly, and Brooke. I hope I got everybody's name correct. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives from Volvo, the Virginia 250 truck. The chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I am informed that in the gallery today we're joined by some, I don't know whether they're students or students and

[00:51:15] faculty or parents, from Shenandoah Valley Christian School. I would ask you to extend to them the warm welcome of the Senate. It's good to see them up in gallery this morning it's a nice size group thank you senator for that introduction and looks like we have a mixture please remain standing so that we can fully recognize you looks like we have students we have parents and teachers i think so we

have the full representation of shenandoah valley christian school we're so delighted that you have visited us today in the capital that

[00:51:51] you're here in our Senate gallery. I hope you're having a wonderful opportunity to chat with legislators all throughout the day and talk about the issues that are important to you. Thank you so much for being here. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to our students, faculty, and parents from

[00:52:11] Shenandoah Valley Christian School. Is there any other business to come before the morning hour the clerk will call the calendar senate calendar for wednesday february 25th

[00:52:44] 2026 page 3 unfinished business senate senate bill 37 has passed the house with an amendment the senator from arlington good afternoon madam president madam president i move that we concur with the house amendment and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor um thank you madam president what the house did is they added the words scientific scientifically reliable

[00:53:18] when we're talking about tests that may be used when an adult is now seeking civil action or civil remediation because she was sexually assaulted in infancy as a minor or at a state of incapacity the bill lays out a process by which the aggrieved could petition the court for civil damages the reliability on tests dna and other tests is specified this the house felt it was important

[00:53:54] to put the phrase scientifically reliable that we think is a reasonable addition and i hope it is the will of the body to concur with the house amendment the question is shall the senate concur with the house with the house amendment to senate bill 37 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[00:54:29] senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 40 no zero eyes 40 knows zero the senate concurs senate bill 70 pass the house with a substitute with amendment the senator from arlington uh thank you madam president madam president i move that we concur with the substitute and the amendment and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president um what this the house did is they took our senate bill which was a recommendation

[00:55:08] from the commission on youth and it talked about diversion services available to a delinquent before adjudication that was our bill what the house did is they just made court services available to the juvenile before they even petitioned the court this was something that we thought was in with the intent of the bill it emphasized again the value of diversion services especially when you're talking about juveniles so it i hope it is the will of the body to concur with the substitute

[00:55:42] and the amendment. Thank you. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendment to Senate Bill 70? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 117 has

[00:56:20] pass the house with a substitute the senator from Western Fairfax thank you madam president I move that the Senate concur with the house and speaking to that senator has the floor yeah the house put all of their minds together to work hard on this bill and basically added a comma to our bill so you know I I think we should pass this very fine bill with the very important comma.

[00:56:56] Senator, commas are very critical. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 11-7?

[00:57:13] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[00:57:28] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 35, nos 5. Ayes 35, nos 5. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 136 has passed the House with a substitute. The chair recognizes the Senator from Chesapeake.

[00:57:47] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I ask that the Senate concur with the House substitute and speak into that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. What the House did was make this bill just a little bit more stronger in its deliberation. the earlier version allowed a judge to reduce probation without a hearing based solely on the discretion. The substitute requires the Department of Corrections to review the case first and formally request the reduction. This just adds a second layer of oversight. If someone earns early termination, it must be verified by the supervising authority. Compliance is documented, risk is

[00:58:23] evaluated, and victims are notified. If a judge wants a hearing, they can still hold one. This is structured accountable responsible bill and i asked my colleagues to concur with the house substitute the question is shall the senate concur with the house substitute for senate bill 136.

[00:58:42] all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk we'll close the roll. Ayes 32, noes 8. Ayes 32, noes 8. The Senate concurs.

[00:59:06] Senate Bill 203 has passed the house with a substitute. The Senator from Roanoke. Madam President, I move with the recommendation it be rejected, I move we concur with the house substitute and then speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. The chair of the Education Committee just asked me a few minutes ago to reject their substitute. They have a companion bill. They have adopted our position and they are going to recede from our position once this is communicated or recede from

[00:59:43] their position once this is communicated. So with that I move that we concur with the recommendation that we do not. With the recommendation that it be rejected the The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 203?

[01:00:05] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote?

[01:00:21] The Clerk will close the roll. Aye zero, noes 40. Aye zero, noes 40. The Senate does not concur. Bill 316 has passed the House with a substitute. The senator from Tazewell.

[01:00:39] Thank you, Madam President. I move that we agree to the House substitute and explain in that motion. Senator has the floor. The substitute actually had some small technical edits to satisfy the request made by notaries that did two things that clarified the code language and the enactment clause that the notary education could be curriculum developed by the Secretary of the Commonwealth or developed by a third party and approved by the Secretary. Then the second thing the substitute did was vendors or manufacturers of notary seals shall retain such proof of commission for five years

[01:01:17] instead of four. With that explanation, I move that we concur. The Senator from Chesapeake. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House, the Senate will be temporarily at ease

[01:01:38] With the recommendation that the Senate concur with the House substitute,

[01:04:34] the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 316? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:04:51] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. The Senate concurs. Senate bill 360 has passed the house with a substitute the senator from King George thank you madam president I would move that we concur with the house substitutes speaking to that motion senator has the floor as much as it pains me madam president I do think they made an improvement to this bill and this is the galaxy gas bill where these children are huffing it and they're

[01:05:28] getting really serious problems they made some clarifications to make sure we're not limiting medical use by doctors and dentists and such and we also added flavored nitrous oxide which was not in the original bill and then there was an exclusion for the ready whip and those sorts of things because they do apparently have some in it so it's a good bill

[01:06:01] Madam President and and I hope everybody will support the substitute. The question is shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 360? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes

[01:06:36] zero the Senate concurs Senate bill 416 has passed the house with amendment the senator from northern Fairfax thank you madam chair I move that we concur with the house amendment speaking to that brief senator has the floor thank you madam madam president this is dealing with people with autism intervening with the courts the senator from King George and I work together on it the the house made a very tiny amendment that simply added the word

[01:07:09] district in after juvenile and domestic relations courts so I move that we accept and concur with the house amendment the question is shall the Senate concur with a house amendment to Senate bill 416 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 29, noes 11. Ayes 29, noes 11. The Senate

[01:07:47] concurs. Senate bill 480 has passed the House with a substitute. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that we concur with the amendment and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this bill is a cognate to House bill 1084 which is on the consent agenda later this morning. The The amendments clarify that any data that contains personal or case-identifying information shall be kept confidential and not subject to FOIA.

[01:08:17] The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 480? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:08:32] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0. Ayes 40, no 0. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 495 has passed the House with amendments. Senator from

Charlottesville.

[01:08:49] Madam President, I move that we concur with the House amendment. I'd like to speak to that, please. Senator has the floor. Madam President, unlike the last bill, this bill has a cognate that's not on the consent docket. it's a it was partisan vote on in both both bodies it's a deals with the constructive possession of firearms and substantial risk orders of red red light the red flag law this bill makes technical amendments and you can see the amendments in the calendar simply acknowledges that the the enforcement of this work is going to be done at the local level so it substitutes local

[01:09:28] departments of social services for the State Department of Social Services again I hope you concur with the amendment The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendments to Senate Bill 495? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye.

[01:09:45] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19.

[01:10:01] The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 649 has passed the House with amendment. The senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I move to that we concur with the House Amendment. Speaking of that. Senator has the floor. Grammarians in the House identified an extra and extraneous period at the end of one of the sentences.

[01:10:21] That is the only change made in this bill. Periods are also good, Senator. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House Amendment to Senate Bill 649?

[01:10:40] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:11:01] Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. The Senate concurs. Uncontested calendar, house bills on third reading. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move on all the house bills on third reading on the uncontested calendar, pages 9 through 15 house bill 62 through house bill 9 or 1477 be advanced their final passage in a block after the adoption of any amendments thereto any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill the question is shall the house bills on the uncontested calendar third reading pages 9 through 15 house bill 62 through

[01:11:40] house bill 1477 be placed now on their final passage in a block after the adoption of any amendments thereto with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the bills are before us in the block the clerk will read the number of the bills house bill 62 reported from the committee on local Government House Bill 63 reported from the Committee on Local Government House

[01:12:16] Bill 98 reported from the Committee on Local Government House Bill 101 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice House Bill 135 reported from the Committee on Local Government House Bill 245 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice House Bill 248 reported from the Committee on Local on local government. House bill 305 reported from the committee on local government. House bill 388 reported from the committee on local government with a substitute. The senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you madam president I move

[01:12:55] the committee substitute. The question is shall the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 552, reported from the Committee on Local Government. House Bill 657, reported from the Committee on Local Government. House Bill 792, reported from the Committee on Local Government. House Bill 887, reported from the Committee on Local Government.

[01:13:30] House Bill 940, reported from the Committee on Local Government. House Bill 1050 reported from the Committee on Local Government. House Bill 1084 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 1300 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. House Bill 1477 reported from the Committee on Local Government. The question is, shall the House bills in the block pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote. Have all the Senators voted. Do any Senators desire to

[01:14:10] change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. The bills in the block pass. Regular calendar. House bills on third reading.

[01:14:26] House bill 77. A bill relating to enforcement of federal traffic infractions by state and local law enforcement officers. Planning District 8. reported from the Committee on Transportation with an amendment and there is a floor substitute. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. With the recommendation be rejected I would move the committee amendment. With the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the amendment from the Committee on Transportation be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed no. The committee amendment is

[01:15:04] is rejected. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I moved to waive reading of the floor sub. The question is, shall the reading of the floor substitute be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. Aye. Let me try that again. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading is waived. Senator. Thank you, Madam President. I move the floor sub be agreed to and speak that motion.

[01:15:38] Senator has the floor. Thank you, ladies and gentlemen. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate, this bill is the cognate of a bill that I carried early in session, Senate Bill 81, if you want to go look it up. For some reason, the House patron did not ask that the bill actually be conformed to what we passed.

[01:15:58] And so all this does is conforms it to what we already passed. The vote in our chamber was 26-14, for anybody's reference. Again, it was Senate Bill 81. But the bill basically has to do with park police enforcement. Mostly in the district I represent the GW Parkway is about seven miles in my district and there's a little stretch of it that runs From the city of Alexandria up to the beltway so myself the senator from Arlington and the senator from Northern Fairfax I think are the only three senators this really affects But the US Park Police has basically stopped conducting traffic enforcement the bill basically just says that the county police the state police can do it

[01:16:37] Or they can install speed cameras if the Park Service will actually agree, but the for some reason the bill wouldn't conform I'm just asking to be conformed so it'll probably just go to conference but again it was 26 14 when it came out here that's all this does it's nothing new you haven't seen already the question is shall the floor substitute be agreed to all in favor of the motion we'll say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the floor substitute is agreed to senator from eastern Fairfax move the bill be agreed to and speak to that motion senator has the floor thank you man president appreciate the

[01:17:15] body's patience again this is now identical to what we already passed and myself and my my my colleague in the house need to have a little conversation about how to wrap this up and we'll do that in conference and I hope we get past again the question is shall house bill 77 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[01:17:50] the roll. Ayes 26, noes 14. Ayes 26, noes 14. House Bill 77 passes. House Bill 93. A bill relating to firearm transfers to another person from a prohibited person reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendments. The senator from Alexandria. Thank you Madam President. I move the committee amendment. The question is shall the committee shall the amendment from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of

[01:18:24] that motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the committee amendment is agreed to senator from alexandria thank you madam president i move the bill pass and speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you madam president this bill is identical to senate bill 38 patroned by the senator from arlington which passed this body 21 to 19. it gives law enforcement a mechanism to ensure that convicted domestic abusers do not have access to illegal guns and i move the bill pass. The question is, shall House Bill 93 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all

[01:19:04] the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19, House Bill 93 passes. House Bill 168, a bill relating to election of certain governing bodies, conversion to single member districts reported from the committee on local government with a substitute the senator from Eastern Henrico thank you madam president I move the committee substitute the question is shall the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to all in favor of

[01:19:39] that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Henrico thank you madam president I now move that we move Senate Health Bill, excuse me, 168 forward and speaking to that motion. Pass and speaking to the motion. Yes. Senator has the floor. We passed the bill and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 168 is the, is similar to Senator Rouse's Senate Bill

[01:20:14] 51 and this requires that every locality with a population of 400,000 allow for individual single member member districts it also allows for the presiding officer to be elected at large and further it allows for the establishment of the required district to reapportion in accordance with the law question is shall house bill 168 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[01:20:50] senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, Noes 17. Ayes 23, Noes 17. House Bill 168 passes. House Bill 187, a bill which provided a charter for the city of Virginia Beach relating to city council voting districts. The senator from Eastern Henrico.

[01:21:17] Thank you, Madam President. I move passage of the bill in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 187 is similar to Senator Rouse's Senate Bill 681. This amends the charter for the city of Virginia Beach to reflect the transition of the council consisting solely of a single member district and the mayor. The question is, shall House Bill 187 pass? All in favor of

that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the Senators ready to vote. Have all the Senators voted. Do any Senators desire to

[01:21:56] change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 25, noes 15. Ayes 25, noes 15. House Bill 187 does not pass. The required vote is 27. House Bill 226, a bill relating to County Manager Plan of Government Independent Policing Auditor.

[01:22:23] Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you so much, Madam President. House Bill 226, I move the passage of and speak into that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you so much. Madam President, House Bill 226 allows the governing body, specifically of Arlington County, to appoint an independent policing auditor.

[01:22:43] Again, this is specific to Arlington County. The independent policing auditor can support law enforcement and civilian oversight body created by the governing entity entity and shall have all the powers of the law enforcement civilian oversight excuse me body and so it simply just gives the county the flexibility to structure their oversight over policing in the way that they need to and again this is specific for arlington only the question is shall house bill 226 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes i those opposed no are the

[01:23:19] senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, Noes 19. Ayes 21, Noes 19. House Bill 226 passes.

[01:23:38] House Bill 247, a bill relating to deferred disposition in a criminal case, persons with autism, intellectual disabilities, or developmental disabilities. Expungement reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute.

[01:23:56] The Senator from Northern Fairfax. thank you madam president i move we pass the bill and uh speak uh pass the uh substitute and the question is shall the substitute from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from fairfax thank you madam president um we just passed the senate the house the senate version is a couple of minutes ago this should be exactly identical and I move that we pass again it's the deferred disposition for people with autism and

[01:24:33] intellectual disabilities the question is shall House bill 247 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 32 noes 8 ayes 32 noes

[01:25:03] House bill 702, a bill to direct local law enforcement agencies to implement a firearm give-back program or a firearm buy-back program. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with the substitute. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank You Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion.

[01:25:33] Senator, we must adopt the substitute first. Okay, I move the committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:25:48] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Fairfax. I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Ladies and gentlemen, this is a bill that you have not seen yet. All the others I think so far have been cognates. This one is new.

[01:26:04] This bill came over to us as a Section 1 bill, which we did not understand why it was Section one because it basically requires when it came to us it said every locality in the state was required to have a firearm buyback program and first of all we thought that belonged in the code and not in section one would be buried in the acts of assembly for nobody to find even though it was perpetually applicable so we put it into 15.2 so it'd be in code and then the second thing we did was we said with regard to towns towns only have to optionally establish a gun buyback

[01:26:40] program. The reason for that is because under this bill, counties would be required to do so. So the county overlaying the town would already have one. So we didn't think we needed to require every town to also have a gun buyback program if their county already had one, especially when you're talking about some towns that are really small. So those are basically the two changes we made in the Courts of Justice Committee. Otherwise, I think the purpose of the bill is pretty straightforward. There's some other details in there about what happens to guns and all that kind of stuff. But that's basically what the bill does. I hope we get past it. The question is,

[01:27:17] shall House Bill 702 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. House Bill 702 passes.

[01:27:40] House Bill 901, a bill relating to substantial risk orders, eligible petitioners, substantial risk factors and considerations, court jurisdiction, constructive possession of firearms penalty.

[01:27:57] Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this bill is a cognate, and with the bill we passed just a few minutes ago, the amendments to the Senate bill we passed, it's in exactly the same shape as we've already passed for the red flag changes, or the changes that basically expand the number of people who can apply for a red flag petition and make other technical changes to that code section.

[01:28:28] Hope you'll pass the bill. The question is, shall House Bill 901 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted.

[01:28:44] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. House Bill 901 passes. House Bill 1342, a bill which provided a charter for the city of Fairfax relating to city elections powers.

[01:29:07] Reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute. The Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Local Governments be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[01:29:25] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move passage of the bill in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you. Madam President, House Bill 1342 is similar to Senator Salim's Senate Bill 581.

[01:29:42] It amends the charter for the city of Fairfax, excuse me, for Fairfax County to align it with current law requiring municipal elections to occur in November. And further, it also removes the limit of $50 per meeting for compensation of members of their boards and commissions and provides that such

compensation is in the amount established by their board. And so, Madam President, again I move passage of the bill. The question is, shall House Bill 1342 pass?

[01:30:11] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 16. Ayes 24, noes 16. House Bill 1342 does not pass. The required vote is 27. House bill 1404, a bill relating to local governing

[01:30:46] bodies and appointment of youth representative reported for the committee on local government. The senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move passage of the bill and speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House bill 1404 is a bill that we are seeing for the first time and it simply allows for a governing body from a permissive standpoint to appoint a non-voting youth representative to their local board.

[01:31:16] That really is what the bill does. Move passage. The question is, shall House Bill 1404 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:31:36] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 28, Noes 12. Ayes 28, Noes 12, House Bill 1404 passes.

[01:31:51] Uncontested Calendar House Bill is on second reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Senator from Shenandoah.

[01:32:08] Madam President, after voting on the prevailing side, can I ask if we reconsider House Bill 187? question is shall the vote by which the senate i'm sorry the but the vote by which house bill 187 on page 17 did not pass be reconsidered all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators

[01:32:40] desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero the motion is agreed to madam senator from shenandoah madam president could i ask that house bill 187 go by for the day without objection house bill 187 goes by for the day madam madam president senator from shenandoah after voting on the prevailing side could i ask we reconsider house

[01:33:12] bill 1342 the question is shall the vote by which the senate did not pass house bill 1342 on page 18 be reconsidered all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 40 no zero ice 40 no zero the motion is agreed to senator from shenandoah yes madam president i would ask that house bill 1342 go by for the day

[01:33:52] also please without objection house bill 1342 goes by for the day uncontested calendar house bills on second reading the senator from eastern fairfax madam president move all the house bills on second reading on the uncontested regular counters pages 19 through 30 house bill 60 through 1487 that the rules be suspended in the second constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the second reading of the titles of the house bills on the uncontested and regular calendars pages 19 through 30 house bill 60 through house

[01:34:30] bill 1487 be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the

clerk will close the roll it's 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero the reading of the titles is dispensed with senator from eastern fairfax President, I ask that all those bills go by for the day.

[01:35:00] The question is, shall the House bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, now on their third reading, go by for the day? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:35:17] The bills will go by for the day.

[01:35:29] Page 30, regular calendar, Senate bill on second reading. Senate bill 30. Senate Bill, that's it. Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:35:46] Madam President, pursuant to Senate Rule 23A, I move that Senate Bill 30 be made a special and continuing order at the conclusion of the Senate calendar on Thursday, February 26, 2026.

[01:36:03] The question is, shall Senate Bill 30 be made a special and continuing order at the conclusion of the Senate calendar on Thursday, February 26, 2026. All in favor of agreeing to the motion will record their votes, aye.

[01:36:19] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no, zero.

[01:36:37] Ayes 40, no, zero. The special and continuing order is set for Senate Bill 30 at the conclusion of the Senate calendar. on Thursday, February 26, 2026. The Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I now move that Senate Bill 30 be passed by for the day.

[01:36:57] Without objection, Senate Bill 30 is passed by for the day. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry to the Clerk. Does that complete today's calendar? Yes, sir.

[01:37:14] Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President, for, I guess, an announcement.

[01:37:31] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, a couple things. First of all, we had a couple of charter bills that went down today. I would just please ask people to pay attention, save us some time, because that's going to probably cost us five or ten minutes tomorrow, one thing.

[01:37:51] Second thing, as these amendments keep coming back from the House of Delegates and go straight floor. I would just please ask that unless something is purely technical, if there's any substance to it, please go to the committee chair that it came through and talk to them about the policy change before you tell us what to do on the floor. That'll also probably help us avoid some delays and miscommunications. Don't just assume that everything's good because the House

[01:38:24] said so. So I just want to give everybody that advice as we go forward. A lot of House stuff coming back in the next few days. Otherwise, see everybody in courts in a few minutes. The clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Today, Wednesday, February 25th, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet 30 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room A, GAB. The Committee on General Laws and Technology will meet 30 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room B, GAB. The

[01:39:04] General Laws and Technology Subcommittee on Housing will meet immediately upon adjournment of the Committee on General Laws and Technology in Senate Room B, GAB. Tomorrow,

Thursday, February 26th, the Hampton Roads Caucus will not meet.

[01:39:21] The Committee on Education and Health will meet at 8.30 a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol, and the Republican Caucus will meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol.

[01:39:39] This is a reminder that the budget out-of-block request and any floor amendments are due to the desk staff by 5 p.m. today. The Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, rise for an announcement.

[01:40:00] Senator has the floor. Madam President, the Senate Republicans will meet immediately upon recess downstairs in our room. The Senior Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an announcement.

[01:40:15] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Tomorrow morning at 8 a.m., we have the Aviation Caucus in room 600B. Again, the Aviation Caucus at 8 a.m. tomorrow morning. Thank you. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth.

[01:40:41] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow. The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:40:57] The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow.

[01:41:18] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

[01:41:59] and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[01:42:34] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

